

A Day in Seville

Capital of Andalusia for more than 800 years, Seville is southern Spain's seat of power and glory, and boasts magnificent palaces and churches. The city's grace and joy are expressed in sweet gardens, tiled patios, and the catharsis of its signature flamenco, the *Sevillana*.

MORNING Begin with the wondrous **Real Alcázar** before touring the **Cathedral**, which holds the tomb of Columbus. Climb the ramps of **La Giralda** to survey the medieval maze of **Barrio Santa Cruz**, where whitewashed houses line narrow, cobbled streets and are interspersed with quaint tapas bars and centuries-old gardens.

AFTERNOON Visit the exquisite palace and gardens of **La Casa de Pilatos**. Don't miss the haunting paintings of saints by Zubarán in the **Museo de Bellas Artes**. Founded by a famous dancer, the **Museo del Baile Flamenco** charts the flowering of the art form.

EVENING Return to the **Museo del Baile Flamenco** if a dance performance is scheduled, or catch equally authentic flamenco music and dance at **Los Gallos**.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Flights arrive into **Seville Airport**, 6 miles (10 km) from downtown Seville. **Buses** from the airport take 25 minutes and run every half-hour; **car rental** and **taxis** are available.

WHERE TO STAY

YH Giralda (inexpensive) squeezes intimate but cheerful rooms on three levels around a central courtyard in a former abbots' residence. www.yh-hoteles.com

La Hostería del Laurel (moderate) is a romantic and atmospheric old inn where *Don Juan* was written. www.hosteriadellaurel.com

Hotel EME Fusion (expensive) brings luxurious avant-garde designer sensibility to the plaza next to the cathedral. www.emehotel.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

Plaza de San Francisco; www.turismo.sevilla.org



Right Like a raw vegetable smoothie, gazpacho is often served chilled in glasses as a thirst-quenching appetizer

Below The Salon de los Embajadores (Hall of the Ambassadors) in the Real Alcázar

